



Contexts

Political context

- Newspapers reflect the political context in which they were made through their ideology and the way they represent certain stories. This context is also evident through aspects of their ownership, political orientation and readers. The media mediates issues and events in the news, particularly more complex stories including international relationships. These can be represented by the newspaper through, for example, what is selected and what is omitted, the sources referenced and the way in which language is used. It is important to be aware of how different newspapers present their stories and their view of the world in different ways and how this may reflect an ideological viewpoint.
- The pages of the set issue of the *Daily Mirror* to be studied reflect an obvious political allegiance and a left-wing ideology through the way in which it constructs the chosen story and the representation of Keir Starmer and the Labour government.

Social and cultural contexts

- All newspapers, including the *Daily Mirror*, reflect the social and cultural contexts of the time in which they were produced. The *Daily Mirror* largely targets a lower-middle-class/working-class readership which is evident through the **news values** of the paper, the selection of stories and how particular social groups are represented.
- The choice to focus on this particular story also reinforces a common social theme for this newspaper – its role in championing the ordinary person and their concerns. The newspaper focuses clearly on what the deal will mean for their readers and how they will benefit.
- The newspaper's plug also reflects a cultural context advertising 'Free Summer Racing Tickets' and reinforcing the cultural heritage of the UK. The references to the Chelsea Flower Show, the royal family and relatable celebrities further reinforce the social and cultural aspect of the newspaper and the stories that will engage its readers.